

4. Short stocks/markets

The flip side of bubble trading is to identify wildly overvalued companies or markets and then bet against them. Sure, the crowd is right most of the time, but when they are wrong, it's spectacular.

You will need a steel gut to deal with the short squeezes and vitriol that come your way—this is why short sellers have become an endangered species—but surely it's worth it.

- Degree of difficulty: 9/10
- Likelihood of success: 4/10
- Time required: 6 months to 3 years

Bonus points: Identifying the frauds the regulators missed...

5. Time the market

Markets go up, markets go down, how hard can it be to be on the right side of the trend?

- Degree of difficulty: 7/10
- Likelihood of success: 3/10
- Time required: Whenever the next major reversal occurs.

6. Provide a valuable service

Now, we're getting into some heavy lifting. Figure out how to provide some sort of service, be it research, execution, asset management, or simply identifying the things everybody else has missed. Then, monetize that service.

- Degree of difficulty: 7/10